

Jiusheng Zhu

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EDUCATION

Ph.D in Economics Monash University, Australia	July 2025 - present
M.A in Economics Monash University, Australia	July 2024 - July 2025
M.A in Economics Beijing Normal University, China	Sept 2020 - June 2023
B.A in Economics University of International Relations, China	Sept 2014 - June 2018

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labor Economics, Political Economics.

PUBLICATIONS

- Jiusheng Zhu***, Xinjie Zhang, Yu Zhao, Xiaoyang Ye. [Information for Vision: Experimental Evidence on Nudging Low-income Students to Wear Eyeglasses](#), *Economics of Education Review*, 2026. (ABS 2; ABDC: A)
- Jiusheng Zhu**, Lifang Zhang*. [Housing Choice Under School Admission Uncertainty: Evidence From China's School Lottery](#), *Journal of Regional Science*, 2025. (ABS 3; ABDC: A)
- Juan Yang, Lifang Zhang*, **Jiusheng Zhu**. [Decision-making as cognitive household labor: Higher education expansion, women empowerment, and their intra-household decision-making responsibility](#), *China Economic Review*, 2025. (ABS 2; ABDC: A)
- Lifang Zhang, **Jiusheng Zhu***. [Can higher education improve egalitarian gender role attitudes? evidence from china](#), *China Economic Review*, 2024. (ABS 2; ABDC: A)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Does Power Age the Leader? Evidence from National Leaders' Facial Aging**

Abstract: Does winning national executive office make leaders age faster? I study this question using a one- to-one matched sample of election winners and the opponents they defeated, which isolates the effect of taking office from the traits of those who seek it. I measure apparent age directly from photographs with two machine-learning models, DEX and DeepFace, and define facial aging as the gap between predicted apparent age and true age. Comparing winners and losers before and after elections in a difference-in-differences design, I find that winning office accelerates apparent aging, and that the effect emerges most strongly after leaders leave office: during tenure winners look about 1.1 years younger than matched losers, but about 3.1 years older once they step down (DEX). Dynamic event studies trace the same pattern over time. Two forces appear to combine. Office-related stress and its cumulative health burden drive the aging that surfaces after leaders leave, while the youthfulness observed during tenure largely reflects masking. Consistent with this, winners' hair greying is suppressed in office and jumps sharply at stepdown, and removing hair from the age models roughly halves the in-office effect. A larger apparent-age gap is also associated with lower approval the following year. The response is uneven, falling more heavily on male, developing-country, and two-term leaders—patterns consistent with sustained cosmetic masking by women, heavier governing burdens in poorer economies, and longer cumulative exposure to office.

PRESENTATIONS

2024: AEFPP (March 14), AERA (April 11)

2023: Annual Conference of Labor Economics for Chinese Economists (Peking University, August 2023), Education Finance for Chinese Economists Under 40 (Peking University, March 2023), Peking University Summer School (July 2023)

HONORS AND AWARDS

MONASH BUSINESS SCHOOL DEAN'S EXCELLENCE AWARD	September 2025
MONASH BUSINESS SCHOOL GRADUATE RESEARCH SCHOLARSHIP	September 2025
Excellent Paper, 2024 AERA Annual Meeting	April 2024
Second Prize Paper Award, Education Finance for Chinese Economists Under 40	March 2023
Outstanding Young Scholar of Education Finance and Policy, Peking University	Aug 2022
Outstanding Reviewer, Annual Conference of Labor Economics for Chinese Economists	July 2022
Best Student Paper, 2023 Graduate School of Education Summer School, Peking University	July 2023
Best Student Paper, 2022 Graduate School of Education Summer School, Peking University	July 2022
Second Class University Fellowship, Beijing Normal University	2020-2023

REFeree SERVICES

Journal of Housing Economics, Applied Economics, Chinese Sociological Review, China Economic Quarterly

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Monash University:

- Chinese Economy and Global Business (2025-2026, Undergraduate & Postgraduate)
- Managerial Economics (2025-2026, Postgraduate)

Beijing Normal University:

- Introductory Microeconomics (2021-2023, Undergraduate)
- Economic History of China (2023, Undergraduate)

RELEVANT COURSES

Advanced Econometrics, Advanced Microeconomics, Advanced Macroeconomics, Advanced Microeconometrics, Game Theory, Behavioral Economics, Experimental Economics

SKILLS

- **Software:** Python, Stata, R, Qgis, L^AT_EX
- **Language:** English (fluent), Chinese (native)